



Museum director quits amid standoff

National Portrait Gallery head kept working after Trump said she was fired

BY SOPHIA NGUYEN, RACHEL HATZIPANAGOS AND GEOFF EDGERS

Kim Sajet, the director of the Smithsonian's National Portrait Gallery, stepped down from her role Friday, two weeks after President Donald Trump said on social media that he had fired her.

The resignation stunned leaders in the museum world, who had been relieved earlier this week when the body overseeing the Smithsonian Institution affirmed that only its secretary could hire and fire museum leaders.

Sajet's decision was revealed in an internal email sent just before noon to Smithsonian staff. In it, Smithsonian Secretary Lonnie G. Bunch III wrote, "We are grateful to Kim for leading the National Portrait Gallery with passion and creativity for 12 years."

Bunch highlighted how Sajet had expanded the gallery's collection with "key acquisitions," such as the earliest known daguerreotype of first lady Dolley Madison. He added: "Her decision to put the museum first is to be applauded and appreciated. I know this was not an easy decision."

The email also included a message from Sajet, calling it the "honor of a lifetime" to lead the

SEE SAJET ON A2

Army roiled by political turmoil ahead of its birthday

BY DAN LAMOTHE

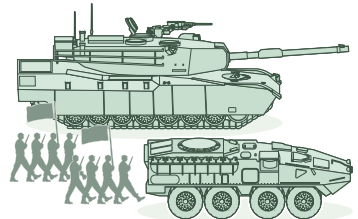
When President Donald Trump took to a dais at Fort Bragg in North Carolina this week, he opened by praising the courage and toughness of the American soldier. But soon, with a phalanx of camouflaged paratroopers behind him, his speech took a dramatic turn.

He declared that people who burn the U.S. flag should be jailed, despite First Amendment protections established by the Supreme Court. He trashed the news media, a favorite foil. And he needled political opponents, including former president Joe Biden.

"You think this crowd would have showed up for Biden?" Trump said, as soldiers laughed and booed. "I don't think so."

The partisan display, though downplayed by the president's faithful, has left senior Army leaders disappointed and concerned, said three defense officials. Soldiers are taught that "the Army as an institution must be nonpartisan and appear so too," while "not

SEE ARMY ON A4



Map and graphics: What you can expect to see at the D.C. parade. B2

Military might: Around the world, displays are routine spectacles. A9

Iran retaliates, with no end in sight



MAJID SAEEDI/GETTY IMAGES

A crew extinguishes a fire in a building in Tehran that was destroyed in an Israeli attack Friday. Iran's ambassador to the U.N. said at least 78 people were killed in the Israeli strikes.



LEO CORREA/AP

Israel's Iron Dome air defense system fires to intercept missiles over Tel Aviv on Friday. The Israeli military said few missiles hit their targets, but at least one appeared to strike central Tel Aviv.

ISRAEL SAYS IT INTERCEPTED MOST MISSILES

Both sides accuse the other of crossing 'red lines'

BY SUSANNAH GEORGE

Iran unleashed a barrage of ballistic missiles at Israel late Friday as it retaliated for the waves of Israeli strikes that killed top military leaders and nuclear scientists, and damaged a key uranium enrichment site.

Iran's supreme leader, Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, announced the start of the retaliatory attack in a recorded message carried by state television. "We will not allow them to get away with this great crime they committed," he said. "The Armed Forces of the Islamic Republic will deal heavy blows to this enemy."

Most of the missiles were intercepted or fell short, the Israel Defense Forces said Friday, but at least one appeared to have slammed into central Tel Aviv in an area where a major military base is located.

"Iran has crossed red lines by daring to fire missiles at civilian population centers in Israel," Defense Minister Israel Katz said. "We will continue to defend the citizens of Israel and will ensure that the Ayatollah regime pays a very heavy price for its criminal actions."

Israeli leaders have portrayed the campaign as a preemptive strike on Iran's nuclear program. For years, Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu has argued that only military force would denuclearize Iran.

But after a year of crippling military and strategic setbacks, including the loss of key allies in Lebanon and Syria, Iran has a limited arsenal with which to fight back. And it's unclear how Tehran plans to match Israel's escalation, which could last days or weeks, according to Israeli officials.

Iran and Israel, longtime rivals, began openly trading blows last year as part of the regional spillover from the war in Gaza. But the

SEE IRAN ON A12

Fusillade won't lead to goal of a denuclearized foe, experts say

BY GERRY SHIH AND KAREEM FAHIM

JERUSALEM — As the sun rose over Tehran on Friday, the startling scale of Israel's surprise attack on Iran became evident: Israeli forces, supported by a covert Mossad operation months in the making, severely damaged the Iranian nuclear facility at Natanz, destroyed some of Iran's ballistic missile arsenal and killed half a dozen senior Iranian military leaders and nuclear scientists in a flurry of 100 airstrikes.

But even as Israeli officials celebrated their masterstroke at the operational level, Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu did not appear any closer to realizing his strategic goal of a denuclearized Iran, analysts said. Instead, they said, Netanyahu risked pushing the Middle East into a protracted war, further antagonizing Arab neighbors, including some he has courted, and scuttling the chances of President Donald Trump's ongoing nuclear talks with Iran that Israeli officials have conceded would be necessary to achieve a lasting solution.

In an interview with Israeli television, Netanyahu's national security adviser, Tzachi Hanegbi, said Friday that Iran's nuclear program

SEE ISRAEL ON A11

Trump: Conflict complicates president's pledge for peace. A11

'Rising Lion': How Mossad readied strike from inside Iran. A12

Nuclear facilities: Damaged but not decapitated, experts say. A14

Kennedy's panel overhaul sows doubts over vaccine availability

BY LENA H. SUN AND LAUREN WEBER

Health and Human Services Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr.'s overhaul of a federal immunization panel has created uncertainty around how widely vaccines will be available this fall and if they'll be free, according to six current and former health officials.

After Kennedy purged the influential committee that recommends vaccines and appointed his own picks, staff at the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention who provide the panel with research have now been pushed aside, according to the officials, who spoke on the condition of anonymity because of fear of retaliation.

With the new advisers scheduled to meet in less than two weeks, other CDC staff are also uncertain whether they will be able to present the necessary scientific and medical data to help the committee make informed decisions, officials said.

It's unclear what direction this new group, which includes vaccine critics, will go, and whether

they'll be able to give the stamp of approval needed for Americans to get free vaccines against the coronavirus and other pathogens in time for the fall vaccine season.

"If we have a system that has been dismantled — one that allowed for open, evidence-based decision-making and that supported transparent and clear dialogue about vaccines — and then

we replace it with a process that's driven largely by one person's beliefs, that creates a system that cannot be trusted," Helen Chu, a professor of medicine and epidemiology at the University of Washington who was ousted from the vaccine committee, said in a news conference Thursday.

HHS spokesman Andrew Nixon

SEE VACCINE ON A2

Love, cancer and pregnancy

Couple's choice to start a family reflects a generation facing illness earlier than ever

This article is by Ariana Eunjung Cha, Drea Cornejo, Jahi Chikwendiu, Dan Keating and Julia Wall

PROVO, UTAH — The baby shower was a mash-up of imaginary worlds: the Mad Hatter's tea party, Neverland, Tatooine.

Tanner Martin, the dad-to-be, sat off to the side, a sherpa blanket across his lap, a whip of plastic tubing around his face tethered to an oxygen tank. As he looked around the room filled with young parents and children, his greatest wish was that he would

live long enough to meet his own daughter.

He smiled as a friend walked in, with a toddler cradled against his chest.

"How's it being a father?" "You're in for a treat, man." "How old is she?" "Nine months." "Nine months ..." Tanner echoed.

The math stung. Tanner was diagnosed with Stage 4 colon cancer in November 2020 at age 25, and since then, life had been a series of starts and

SEE CANCER ON A6



JAHÍ CHIKWENDIU/THE WASHINGTON POST

Tanner Martin snoozes while his wife, Shay Martin, checks on him at a hospital in Utah on May 14. Tanner has Stage 4 colon cancer and hoped to survive long enough to meet the couple's daughter.

IN THE NEWS

Pentagon rattles submarine deal A review of the plan for the U.S. and Britain to supply Australia comes as China ramps up its naval ambitions for regional dominance. A5

Shock, grief after India crash Loved ones are reeling and experts are seeking clues after a jet disaster that kill scores in Ahmedabad. A13

THE NATION Four men escaped from a Newark immigration detention site, Homeland Security said. A8
In the U.S., Kilmar Abrego García pleaded not guilty to human smuggling charges. A14

THE WORLD An American was arrested in the killing of a baby found in Italy with her dead mother. A10
Russian forces are pushing closer to the city of Sumy in northern Ukraine. A10

THE ECONOMY In Congress, Republicans are divided over whether Trump's spending bill will increase or lower national debt. A18
Improve your summer with some new tech gear and services, including an app with hiking trail maps and a portable battery for devices. A18

THE REGION The superintendent of Prince George's County schools will resign after reaching a deal with the school board. B1
A judge ruled that a teenager who pleaded guilty in the 2023 beating death of a District man is not receiving proper treatment. B1

STYLE A D.C. theater puts couples onstage for actual weddings in the finale of "We Are Gathered" performances. C1

SPORTS Murray State heads to the College World Series as an underdog and an emblem of all that remains good in sports. D1

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